



Hello push notifications

The recent beta build of Chrome - Chrome 42 now comes with smartphone like push notifications feature <http://dgit.in/PushChro>

Prime for apps?

If reports are to be believed, Amazon is now working on a Prime feature for its apps subscription service <http://dgit.in/AppPrime>

HOW WE TESTED

Testing these Kids tablets wasn't as simple as testing regular tablets. Purely because of a couple of factors – custom skin on top of base Android Jellybean which made running a lot of benchmarks virtually impossible. For instance, we couldn't get PC Mark for Android to run on all these Kids tablets, try as much as we did. Therefore we had to rethink the synthetic benchmark sheet we normally deploy for testing traditional tablets and tweak it a bit to ensure we only considered benchmarking software that was able to run across all these devices.

Synthetic benchmarks: We ran all synthetic benchmarks at factory settings. For testing CPU and GPU performance, we ran a whole host of browser tests that rated the device's processor and graphics engine. We also managed to run AnTuTu and Quadrant tests on all the devices, thereby making the disappointment of not being able to run Futuremark benchmarks (our most widest range of industry-standard benchmark suite) a lot more palatable. For testing all the tablets' display quality, we made use of a Konica Minolta lightmeter to test individual screen brightness. We also rated every tablet's audio quality and volume levels.

Features analysis: This section of the testing includes a lot of research and verification of

internal hardware claims. The point is to check if all these devices really have the hardware they claim. Wherever possible, we installed AIDA64, an in-depth hardware analysis app for Android that tells you an Android device's hardware in intricate detail. What's the CPU, how many cores, how much internal storage, and other such details. We also took a look at things like the tablet's screen size, display resolution, weight, operating system, connectivity ports, and other physical aspects of the tablets that don't necessarily involve benchmarking or performance testing.

Build and design: While a product's build quality and design highlights are largely dictated by subjective tests (beauty's in the eye of the beholder, remember?), still there are minimum standards that can be arrived at for objectively classifying Device A's build and design characteristics to be better than Device B's, for instance. In this area of our testing, we take into account factors like plastic shell of the tablet – is it just regular plastic or is it reinforced (either by a rubber layer or extra plastic layer) to lend the tablet better build quality. Does the tablet have bigger buttons? Kids need bigger buttons to be able to press them easily (kids are clumsy, yes). What sort of preinstalled, unique

apps and software do these tablets come with to be able to attract a kid's attention? This could be both educational or entertainment software.

Drop test: Again, this isn't something that we do every time we review a tablet. But for Kids Tablets, we reckoned a drop test was an essential thing to have. This is what we did, essentially – we kept each and every tablet we received for the purpose of this test and we kept them on a table whose height measured 3.5 feet from the ground. Without extra force or any added fanfare, we let the tablets slip and "fall" of the table's edge – not one or two times but a total of 10 times. That means 10 falls for each and every tablet. We are glad to report that all tablets survived this test, which is a great story in itself.

Final rating: After taking into account price, we rate performance, features and build by assigning them weights out of 100. And that's how we arrive at our final score. The Best Performing tablet is the one which topped the scores under the performance tests, while the Best Value tablet is the one which gives you the best bang for your buck. The Editor's Pick is decided subjectively by looking at all the scores and rewarding it to a device that had something extra to it, an X factor that other tablets in the comparison lacked.

to tech acumen and more. With game-based learning clearly becoming the future of education, apps for children have an ever-growing market because the children they are targeted towards have an insatiable appetite for content and keep their attention. Eddy offers kids a solution to both their needs, and peace of mind to parents struggling to understand which is the right introductory tablet for their wards.

If you were always apprehensive about giving your smartphone or tablet into your child's hands, not because you know it would be smashed to bits but also because of the effect and negative influence it was causing in a child's development, by getting exposed to

inappropriate content on the Internet – worry no more. Eddy claims to be the first Android-based learning tablet for kids and has been designed by educators. Its content

is linked to school curriculum, and a child can read books, learn to play musical instruments and also practise mathematics through games on the device. How?



Intel Eddy Tablet

Because Intel has paired up with Delhi-based education startup called Metis Learning to curate content, supervise and ensure kids are exposed to the right content, and encouraged to learn through interactive games and apps.

Eddy is a seven-inch tablet that runs on an Intel Atom 1.6 GHz processor. In terms of performance it's the fastest, highest performing Kids tablet we have in this comparison, topping up pretty much every benchmark we threw at it. Even while using the tablet, whether it's creating a parent profile or kids profile, launching the custom Eddy launcher to access the Eddy zone, etc., the tablet felt fastest off the bunch, no doubt. Don't be ready to compare it to a regular